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ETHICS & AUTHORSHIP MINI-GUIDE

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Ethics & Authorship Mini-Guide

Mini-Guide | PDF-ready DOCX

A short scholar-friendly guide to authorship roles, approvals, acknowledgements, and basic manuscript ethics.

How to use this sample: Edit the highlighted placeholders, adapt the tone to your journal, and verify every factual statement before submission.

1. Who should be listed as an author?

An author should have made a meaningful intellectual contribution to the work, participated in drafting or critical revision, approved the final version, and agreed to be accountable for the manuscript.

2. Who belongs in acknowledgements instead?

People who provided routine support, language help, funding administration, access assistance, or technical help may be acknowledged if their contribution does not meet authorship criteria.

3. Approvals to confirm before submission

Approval item	Check
All authors reviewed and approved the final manuscript	☐
Corresponding author details are correct	☐
Ethics approval and consent statements are included where required	☐
Funding and conflict of interest disclosures are complete	☐
AI or editorial assistance disclosures are included if applicable	☐

4. Common authorship mistakes

- Adding a senior name without real contribution.
- Changing author order after submission without transparent agreement.
- Leaving out a contributor who meets authorship criteria.
- Confusing proofreading or formatting help with authorship-level contribution.

5. Practical scholar checklist

- Discuss authorship order early in the project.
- Keep written records of approvals before submission.
- Use the same author names, affiliations, and ORCID details consistently across all files.
- Review journal-specific ethics instructions before final upload.

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